

FACILITATOR COPY

Contains answer keys and grading guidance. Do not publish to students.



2-D Studio Art — Teacher Manual

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · AN EDUCATION EXPERIENCE COMPANY

CPALMS
0101300

GRADE BAND

9–12

STRUCTURE

16 units, 4 quarters, 2-week cycles

LENGTH

Full year, ~36 weeks

DELIVERY

Async On-Demand + 4-day/week live class,
same content

TIME BUDGET

250 min / week

SCHOOL YEAR

2026–2027

HOW TO USE THIS MANUAL

This manual documents the course as it was actually built: 16 studio units across 4 quarters, each a 2-week cycle with one teacher-graded studio project. It gives you the answer keys, rubrics, gradebook setup, and weekly workflow you need to facilitate roughly 500 asynchronous students, plus a live-class adaptation for every unit. Every fact in this manual is read from the finished course build (lesson pages, Canvas item specs, and cycle plans); anything the team could not verify against the build is marked **VERIFY**. Keep this document off the student-facing course. Re-render it from its HTML source whenever a unit is revised.

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1. HOW THIS COURSE WORKS

A typical lesson

Every unit's `Lesson.html` follows the same shape (Unit 1, Unit 6, and Unit 13 were checked directly against the built pages). A student opens the page and moves through, in order:

1. **Look First.** A real artwork with a full-minute looking prompt, before any vocabulary is introduced. Public-domain works embed in full (e.g. Van Gogh's *The Bedroom* in Unit 1); in-copyright works (Matisse, Kahlo, Douglas, Close, Picasso) appear as a "View at the Museum" link card with full citation, never as an embedded image.

- 2. **A no-wrong-answer reflect widget** ("Quick Check-In"), so every student commits to a first response before instruction begins.
- 3. **Name What You See.** The unit's vocabulary and concept, taught through inline HTML/CSS/SVG diagrams (never AI-generated images) plus, where useful, a second real photograph or artifact.
- 4. **Watch It Work (DAIJ).** A full Describe-Analyze-Interpret-Judge walkthrough modeled on the featured work, followed by a "Try It" evaluative widget (single-select, per-answer feedback) and a commit-then-reveal notebook prompt.
- 5. **An AI-awareness callout**, factual and specific to that week's task (what AI can and cannot decide for this particular project).
- 6. **Vocabulary card grid**, then **What You'll Do Next:** the four Canvas items for the cycle (Sketch, VR Session, Quiz, Studio Project), and a one-paragraph Big Idea close.

No benchmark codes, tier labels, or standards ever appear on the student-facing page; those live only in `teacher-cycle-plan.md` and this manual.

A typical week

SEGMENT	WHAT THE STUDENT DOES	GRADED?	TIER
Week 1 • Learn & Look	Read the lesson page (~55 min); complete the Sketch (~30–40 min); complete the VR Session critique (~25–35 min); take the 8-question Quiz (~20 min); remaining time is independent studio practice/planning toward Week 2 (~100–120 min)	Sketch & VR: completion. Quiz: auto-graded.	Tier 1
Week 2 • Make & Reflect	Produce the Studio Project artwork and a 2–3 sentence Artist Statement; sign the work; submit both together as one item	Yes, on the Studio Art 9–12 rubric	Tier 3

Total time budget: 250 minutes/week, ~500 minutes/cycle. There is no separate "reading journal," discussion forum, or weekly comprehension quiz outside this pattern; the cycle's one Tier 1 quiz and one Tier 3 studio submission are the entire graded footprint of a unit besides completion items.

Major assessments

ITEM	WHERE	TIER	WHAT IT ASKS	GRADING TIME
Studio Project + Artist Statement	Every unit, Week 2 (16 total)	3	One finished, signed artwork applying that unit's concept, plus a 2–3 sentence statement	~5 min/student (rubric)
Capstone: Curated Portfolio + Reflective Statement + Virtual Exhibition	Unit 17, the course final grade	3	6–8 curated pieces from across the year, a 6–9 sentence reflective statement, VR exhibition evidence	~8–10 min/student
Sketch	Every unit, Week 1	1	A short study/practice drill tied to that unit's concept	Completion, ~0 min
VR Session	Every unit, Week 1	1	A student-chosen real artwork brought into the student's own VR space, critiqued with DAIJ	Completion, ~0 min
Quiz	Every unit except Unit 17, Week 1	1	8 auto-graded questions, rotating Type A (Elements/Principles) and Type B (Art History)	Auto-graded, 0 min
Self-Assessment Checklist	Unit 17 only, Week 2 (replaces the quiz)	1	12-item Yes/Almost/Not Yet checklist mirroring the capstone rubric	Completion, ~0 min

1B. RUNNING THIS COURSE LIVE, UNIT BY UNIT

This section is additive to the standard manual: a course-wide sample pacing calendar for a 4-day/week live section, then a concrete live-class adaptation for every one of the 16 units. The async build already drives the live class unchanged (per `build-conventions.md`); these boxes translate each unit's own content, not a generic template, into an 8-day (2-week × 4-day) meeting pattern.

Course-wide live-class pacing table

SAMPLE PACING — ADJUST TO YOUR SECTION'S ACTUAL LIVE-CLASS CALENDAR

The syllabus's own milestone table anchors only 8 of the 16 units and is explicitly labeled a sample. The table below lays all 16 units out continuously in order, starting the week of Aug 10, 2026 (first student day Wed Aug 12), using Monday–Thursday as the default 4-day meeting pattern (swap in your section's actual assigned days). It skips only full non-instructional weeks: Thanksgiving week, both winter-break weeks, and both spring-break weeks. Single-day holidays (Labor Day, Columbus Day, Veterans Day, MLK Day, Presidents Day) fall inside a unit's normal week and simply mean that week meets 3 days instead of 4.

QUARTER	UNIT	STUDIO PROJECT	WEEK 1	WEEK 2	NOTES
Q1	1 · Elements of Art	Design Your Dream Room	Wk of Aug 10 (1st day Wed Aug 12)	Wk of Aug 17	
	2 · Cave Art & Line	Contour Animal Drawing	Wk of Aug 24	Wk of Aug 31	
	3 · Islamic Art	Islamic Tile Design	Wk of Sep 7 (Labor Day Mon)	Wk of Sep 14	
	4 · Leonardo & Value	Value Landscape	Wk of Sep 21	Wk of Sep 28	Buffer wk of Oct 5 (3 days) before Q1 closes Fri Oct 9: add a review/critique day.
	— Buffer: week of Oct 5. Q1 closes Friday, Oct 9. —				
Q2	6 · Matisse & Shape	Personal Identity Collage	Wk of Oct 12 (Columbus Day Mon)	Wk of Oct 19	
	7 · Van Gogh & Texture	Texture Animal Drawing	Wk of Oct 26	Wk of Nov 2	
	8 · Greek Sculpture & Form	Water Droplet Drawing	Wk of Nov 9 (Veterans Day Wed)	Wk of Nov 16	Thanksgiving week (Nov 23–27) skipped in full.
	9 · Notan	Notan Design	Wk of Nov 30	Wk of Dec 7	Buffer wk of Dec 14 (5 days) before Q2/fall semester closes Fri Dec 18.
	— Buffer: week of Dec 14. Q2 / fall semester closes Friday, Dec 18. Winter break Dec 21–Jan 1 skipped in full. —				
Q3	10 · Monochromatic Color	Monochromatic Disco Ball	Wk of Jan 4 (resume Tue Jan 5)	Wk of Jan 11	
	11 · The Color Wheel	Color Wheel Design	Wk of Jan 18 (MLK Day Mon)	Wk of Jan 25	
	12 · Aaron Douglas	Storytelling Silhouette Landscape	Wk of Feb 1	Wk of Feb 8	
	13 · Frida Kahlo	Symbolic Self-Portrait	Wk of Feb 15 (Presidents Day Mon)	Wk of Feb 22	Buffer wk of Mar 1 (4 days) before Q3 closes Fri Mar 5.
	— Buffer: week of Mar 1. Q3 closes Friday, Mar 5. —				
Q4	14 · Chuck Close & Grid	Grid Enlargement Drawing	Wk of Mar 8	Wk of Mar 15	Spring break (Mar 22–Apr 5, both weeks) skipped in full.
	15 · Renaissance Perspective	Two-Point Perspective Cityscape	Wk of Apr 5 (resume Tue Apr 6)	Wk of Apr 12	
	16 · Mixed Media / Blackout Poetry	Illustrated Blackout Poetry	Wk of Apr 19	Wk of Apr 26	
	17 · Portfolio & Art Show	Capstone: Portfolio + Statement + Exhibition	Wk of May 3	Wk of May 10	Buffer wks of May 17 & May 24 (2 full weeks) before Q4/year closes Fri May 28.
	— Buffer: weeks of May 17 and May 24. Q4 and the school year close Friday, May 28. —				

FOOTNOTE ON QUARTER-BOUNDARY MATH

Clean 2-week blocks do not land exactly on a quarter's closing date, by design; each quarter leaves a 3-to-5-day (Q1–Q3) or 2-week (Q4) buffer before the boundary. Recommended use: Q1–Q3 buffers are a natural spot for a whole-class review/critique day or two before grades close. The unusually large Q4 buffer (11 school days) is intentional: it gives room for Unit 17's heavier ~8–10 min/student capstone grading load, an Art Show/exhibition event, extended VR gallery-hanging time, and any semester-exam or awards-day obligations that land differently section to section. If your section's actual calendar differs, shift the whole table forward or back; the unit order and 2-week-per-unit rhythm do not need to change.

Per-unit live-class adaptations

Each box below assumes a Monday–Thursday, 4-day/week meeting (adjust the day labels to your section's actual assigned days). The async lesson page, Sketch, VR Session, Quiz, and Studio Project are unchanged; these boxes only resequence them into class meetings.

Unit 1 · The Elements of Art — Van Gogh's *The Bedroom* · Design Your Dream Room

Day 1

Look First on *The Bedroom* as a class; introduce the 7 elements. First-ever VR encounter: teach Gallery Manners now, once, for the whole course.

Day 2

Value Scale + Element Hunt sketch; walk the DAJJ example together.

Day 3

VR Element Gallery Critique, guided since this is students' first solo VR session.

Day 4

Quiz; launch Dream Room with a quick thumbnail brainstorm.

Day 5–6

Dream Room studio work time.

Day 7

Peer critique of in-progress rooms.

Day 8

Finish, write artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 2 · Prehistoric Cave Art & the Power of Line — Contour Animal Drawing

Day 1

Look First on the Altamira bison; wonder question on confident, unbroken line.

Day 2

Blind Contour + Continuous Line sketch; gesture warm-ups.

Day 3

VR Cave-Art Gallery Critique, student's own choice of work.

Day 4

Quiz; students choose their animal reference photo.

Day 5–6

Contour Animal Drawing studio time.

Day 7

Peer critique.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 3 · Islamic Art: Pattern, Balance & Symmetry — Islamic Tile Design

Day 1

Look First on the Met's Iznik tile; introduce motif, radial balance, symmetry.

Day 2

Grid + Radial Thumbnails sketch: compass-and-straightedge practice. This is the time-heavy part; budget extra minutes.

Day 3

VR Islamic Pattern Gallery Critique.

Day 4

Quiz; launch Tile Design. Remind students to finish the geometry before adding color.

Day 5–6

Tile Design studio time (grid first, then color).

Day 7

Peer critique.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 4 · Leonardo & the Power of Value — Value Landscape

Day 1

Look First on da Vinci's Arno Valley drawing; introduce value and chiaroscuro.

Day 2

Value Scale + Shaded Sphere sketch.

Day 3

VR Leonardo Gallery Critique.

Day 4

Quiz; launch Value Landscape.

Day 5–6

Value Landscape studio time.

Day 7

Peer critique. This closes Q1: a good moment for a quick whole-class Q1 wrap-up.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 6 · Henri Matisse and the Art of Shape — Personal Identity Collage

Day 1

First in-copyright artist: open the MoMA link to *Memory of Oceania* together on the projector (never embed it); introduce shape families and negative space.

Day 2

Shape Hunt + Cut-Out Warm-Up sketch; practice freehand cutting.

Day 3

VR Cut-Out Gallery Critique.

Day 4

Quiz; brainstorm personal symbols/shapes for the collage.

Day 5–6

Collage studio time: cutting and arranging.

Day 7

Peer critique.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 7 · Van Gogh and the Texture of Paint — Texture Animal Drawing

Day 1

Look First on *The Starry Night*; introduce actual vs. implied texture.

Day 2

Texture Sampler (9-box grid) sketch.

Day 3

VR Brushwork Gallery Critique.

Day 4

Quiz; launch the 9-step Texture Animal Drawing (steps 1–3: planning).

Day 5–6

Studio time, steps 4–9: mark-making and rendering.

Day 7

Peer critique.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 8 · Greek Sculpture and the Illusion of Form — Water Droplet Drawing

Day 1

Look First on the Met kouros; introduce the four solids and value-creates-form.

Day 2

Shade the Four Solids sketch.

Day 3

VR Sculpture Gallery Critique + Form Study (choice of 4 sculptures).

Day 4

Quiz; observe real water droplets in class before drawing.

Day 5–6

Water Droplet Drawing studio time.

Day 7

Peer critique.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 9 · Notan: The Space Between — Notan Design

Day 1

Look First on Hokusai's *Great Wave*; introduce positive/negative space via the Taijitu.

Day 2

Notan Thumbnail Studies sketch; run the squint test on 2–3 options.

Day 3

VR Japanese Art Gallery Critique.

Day 4

Quiz; demonstrate the cut-and-flip technique.

Day 5–6

Notan Design studio time.

Day 7

Peer critique. This closes Q2 and the fall semester: a natural moment for a fall-semester wrap.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 10 · Monochromatic Color and Value — Monochromatic Disco Ball

Day 1

Open the museum link to Picasso's *Mother and Child* (Blue Period); introduce tint, shade, monochromatic.

Day 2

One-Color Value Scale + Ball Plan sketch.

Day 3

VR Monochromatic Gallery Critique.

Day 4

Quiz; launch the Disco Ball project.

Day 5–6

Disco Ball studio time: mixing tints and shades.

Day 7

Peer critique.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 11 · The Color Wheel — Color Wheel Design

Day 1

Look First on Seurat's *Sunday on La Grande Jatte*; introduce the wheel and optical color mixing.

Day 2

Mix Your Secondaries and Tertiaries sketch.

Day 3

VR Color and Pointillism Gallery Critique.

Day 4

Quiz; brainstorm a personal theme for the wheel.

Day 5–6

Color Wheel Design studio time.

Day 7

Peer critique.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 12 · Aaron Douglas and the Harlem Renaissance — Storytelling Silhouette Landscape

Day 1

Open the museum link to *Aspects of Negro Life*; introduce silhouette, emphasis, value gradation, with neutral historical framing of the Harlem Renaissance.

Day 2

Silhouette Thumbnails + Value Ground sketch.

Day 3

VR Harlem Renaissance Gallery Critique.

Day 4

Quiz; students plan their own story scene.

Day 5–6

Studio time: value-gradient ground first, then silhouette layering.

Day 7

Peer critique.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 13 · Frida Kahlo and the Symbolic Self-Portrait — Symbolic Self-Portrait

Day 1

Open the museum link to *Self-Portrait with Cropped Hair*; introduce symbol, emphasis/focal point, and unity. Send the advance family note (Section 14) before this day if not already sent.

Day 2

Symbol Brainstorm + Composition Thumbnail sketch.

Day 3

VR Self-Portrait Gallery Critique.

Day 4

Quiz; introduce the optional family/community interview enhancement (make clear it is optional and non-graded-separately).

Day 5–6

Self-Portrait studio time.

Day 7

Peer critique. This closes Q3.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 14 · Chuck Close and the Grid Method — Grid Enlargement Drawing

Day 1

Open the museum link to *Study for Self-Portrait*; introduce proportion, scale, the grid method.

Day 2

Grid Copy Warm-Up sketch.

Day 3

VR Photorealism and Grid Gallery Critique.

Day 4

Quiz; students choose and grid their own reference.

Day 5–6

Grid Enlargement studio time; remind students cell-by-cell rendering is time-intensive, keep grid lines light.

Day 7

Peer critique.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 15 · Renaissance Perspective — Two-Point Perspective Cityscape

Day 1

Look First on *The Ideal City*; introduce horizon line and vanishing points.

Day 2

Horizon, Two Points, and Boxes sketch.

Day 3

VR Renaissance Perspective Gallery (choice of Masaccio, Perugino, Raphael).

Day 4

Quiz; lock the horizon line and both vanishing points before any building edges are drawn.

Day 5–6

Cityscape studio time.

Day 7

Peer critique.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 16 · Mixed Media and Blackout Poetry — Illustrated Blackout Poetry

Day 1

Look First on Blake's *The Tyger*; introduce mixed media and blackout poetry, with the public-domain-or-own-writing source rule.

Day 2

Find the Poem sketch: students choose and mark up their source page.

Day 3

VR Text-Art Gallery Critique.

Day 4

Quiz; launch the illustration plan.

Day 5–6

Studio time: illustrating the kept word-path.

Day 7

Peer critique. This is the last regular content unit of the year.

Day 8

Artist statement, sign, turn in.

Unit 17 · Portfolio & Art Show (Capstone) — no new artwork, no quiz

Day 1

Look Back visual; launch the Portfolio Inventory worksheet across the whole year's work.

Day 2

Careers in Art Research: BLS/O*NET lookup, comparison table.

Day 3

Continue gathering/re-photographing chosen pieces; begin the reflective artist statement, DAJ turned inward.

Day 4

Finish the statement draft; first Self-Assessment Checklist pass.

Day 5

VR "Hang Your Show": arrange 6–8 pieces with intentional order.

Day 6

Record the docent-style tour/walkthrough; polish the statement.

Day 7

Final Self-Assessment pass and fixes; preview the exhibit with peers or family if possible.

Day 8

Assemble and submit the capstone; confirm filenames and signatures. Good day for an Art Show/exhibition event to close the year.

2. UNGRADED INTERACTIVES & THE INTRO/OUTRO WRAPPERS

Ungraded interactive activities

Every lesson page carries 1–2 in-page widgets: a no-wrong-answer reflect check-in and an evaluative single-select with per-row feedback (both with a Reset button), plus a commit-then-reveal notebook prompt. These live on the GitHub-deployed `lesson.html` pages, give the student immediate feedback, and produce no Canvas submission. They cost you nothing to grade. Treat them as formation-by-practice: a student who skips one shows up indirectly, in weaker quiz or studio-project performance, not as a missing grade in your gradebook.

Module intro/outro wrappers

VERIFY BEFORE PUBLISH

Every unit's `teacher-cycle-plan.md` states that "module intro/outro wrappers (Canvas-native quizzes) bracket the cycle per optima-canvas-assignments" and are "built at module level, not in this unit folder." This manual's inventory covered only the three per-unit files (`lesson.html`, `canvas-items.md`, `teacher-cycle-plan.md`); no separate wrapper file was found in `04_Final` during this pass. Before publishing, confirm the 16 intro and 16 outro survey quizzes actually exist in Canvas and carry the expected essential-question, confidence-rating, "what's still unclear," and virtue-reflection fields; if they are still pending, build them before the course goes live.

Once built, treat the outro wrapper as your highest-leverage move in the whole course. It is a Canvas Quiz in survey mode, not a wiki page, specifically so responses become sortable cohort data. Spend 15–20 minutes per unit triaging outro responses:

- **Look for:** clusters of low confidence on that unit's concept, repeated "still unclear" answers pointing at the same idea (e.g., several students naming "negative space" after Unit 6, or "vanishing points" after Unit 15).
- **Then:** post a short targeted announcement addressing the confusion, ask Ignite AI to draft a one-paragraph re-explanation you can send, or message the 2–3 students whose answers stand out individually.

3. AI & VR IN THIS COURSE (STUDENT-FACING)

AI

Every unit carries one factual AI-awareness callout tied to that week's task: what an AI image generator or text tool can produce quickly, and what it cannot decide (the compositional or symbolic choices the project is actually grading). No unit requires a specific AI tool. The callout never becomes a persuasive closer; it states the boundary and stops. You will see the same shape in every unit: "an AI tool can do X in seconds; it cannot make decision Y; Y is what is graded here." Speak to this directly if a student asks whether they can "just use AI" for a project: point them back to that unit's own callout.

VR

Every unit's Week 1 includes one VR Session, always the same shape: the student chooses a real, verified artwork (from a short teacher-curated list, or a teacher-approved alternative), brings it into their own VR space, and runs a full DAIJ critique on it, then in most units also makes or arranges something themselves in VR (a cut-out, a form study, a perspective structure, a hung gallery). Submission is a screenshot or short text confirmation, completion-graded. Gallery Manners (etiquette for a shared VR space) is taught once, in Unit 1, and not repeated. The platform itself is never named to students; lessons use "your VR space," "your VR drawing tool," and similar phrasing, and default to student-chosen Location. To review VR work at scale, spot-check a sample of screenshots/text confirmations each cycle rather than reviewing every submission in depth (it is completion-graded); for Unit 17's "Hang Your Show," consider assembling a live gallery walk of student exhibitions as a class event.

4. USING IGNITE AI TO SUPPORT STUDENTS (TEACHER-FACING)

VERIFY

VERIFY BEFORE FINALIZING

Ignite AI's exact feature names and availability vary by Canvas release and by what Optima has enabled. Confirm the current feature set in Optima's Canvas instance before promising a specific button or workflow to a facilitator. Everything below is described functionally, not as a guaranteed feature list.

Ignite AI is the Canvas AI assistant available to you, the teacher, not a student-facing tool. Used well, it makes a 500:1 ratio feel personal without changing who is actually deciding anything. Five functional uses for this course:

1. **Drafting individualized rubric feedback.** Ask it to draft feedback for a Studio Project submission against the Studio Art 9–12 rubric rows; you edit and own the final wording before it reaches a student. This is the single fastest way to keep the ~5 min/student Tier 3 pass fast without making feedback generic.
2. **Summarizing analytics.** Feed it a batch of outro-wrapper responses or quiz-item performance for a unit and ask for the cohort's sticking points (e.g., "which idea did the most students mark unclear after Unit 9?").
3. **Surfacing students who need a nudge.** Ask it to flag students with a pattern (low outro confidence, a missed Sketch+VR pair, a slipping quiz score) and draft a warm, specific check-in message for each; you send only after reading and editing it.
4. **Generating practice variants.** If a student needs another rep on a Tier 1 skill (say, another value-scale drill after Unit 4), ask Ignite AI for a quick variant exercise rather than rebuilding one from scratch.
5. **Communicating with families.** Draft the Unit 12 and Unit 13 advance-notice scripts (Section 14), or a plain-language progress summary, for a specific family; edit for your own voice before sending. Useful too for translating a message into a family's home language.

STANDING RULE

AI drafts, the teacher decides. Never send anything Ignite AI produced to a student or family without reading and editing it first. Never use it to surveil, rank, or auto-penalize a student; every use above is in service of finding students who need help sooner, not building a case against them.

5. GRADING CATEGORIES & CANVAS GRADEBOOK SETUP

The course syllabus sets the grading weights; the gradebook categories below map the built Canvas items to those weights exactly (see also the tier definitions in [optima-canvas-assignments](#)).

ASSIGNMENT GROUP	WEIGHT	WHAT LIVES HERE	GRADING METHOD
Major Studio Projects	60%	The Tier 3 Studio Project + Artist Statement, one per unit (16 total), plus the Unit 17 Capstone	Rubric (SpeedGrader)
Studio Practice & Sketchbook	30%	The Tier 1 Sketch in every unit, plus Unit 17's Portfolio Inventory and Careers in Art Research	Completion
Critiques, Reflections & Quizzes	10%	The Tier 1 VR Session in every unit, the Tier 1 Quiz (Units 1–16), Unit 17's Self-Assessment Checklist, and the module intro/outro wrappers	Completion (VR, Self-Assessment, wrappers) / Auto-graded (Quiz)

Step-by-step Canvas setup

1. Course Settings → Grading → create the three assignment groups above; set weights to 60 / 30 / 10.
2. Assign every Studio Project + Artist Statement and the Unit 17 Capstone to Major Studio Projects; attach the Studio Art 9–12 rubric (Section 7) to each and enable it for grading.
3. Assign every Sketch, plus the Unit 17 Portfolio Inventory and Careers in Art Research, to Studio Practice & Sketchbook; set grading type to Complete/Incomplete.
4. Assign every VR Session, every Quiz, the Unit 17 Self-Assessment Checklist, and both wrapper quizzes per unit to Critiques, Reflections & Quizzes. Set VR Sessions and the Self-Assessment Checklist to Complete/Incomplete; leave Quizzes as points-based auto-grading.
5. Mark both wrapper quizzes as **Survey** (ungraded or minimal-points) in Canvas Quiz settings, not a points quiz, so responses stay analytics rather than a grade.
6. Set your late/missing policy once at the course level; a common choice for this course is to allow Tier 1 re-attempts freely (they are practice) while holding a firmer but still humane policy on the once-per-cycle Tier 3 submission.
7. Use the Modules → Requirements/progress view as your at-a-glance signal for who has completed the ungraded scaffolding (lesson page view, Sketch, VR) without needing to grade any of it.

Gradebook map

ITEM (PER UNIT, ×16 UNLESS NOTED)	ASSIGNMENT GROUP	POINTS/WEIGHT	METHOD
Sketch	Studio Practice & Sketchbook	10 pts	Completion
VR Session	Critiques, Reflections & Quizzes	10 pts	Completion
Quiz (Units 1–16)	Critiques, Reflections & Quizzes	8 questions, auto-scored	Auto-graded
Studio Project + Artist Statement	Major Studio Projects	20 pts (5-row rubric)	Rubric
Module intro/outro wrapper (×2/unit) VERIFY	Critiques, Reflections & Quizzes	Survey/completion	Completion
Unit 17: Portfolio Inventory	Studio Practice & Sketchbook	10 pts	Completion
Unit 17: Careers in Art Research	Studio Practice & Sketchbook	10 pts	Completion
Unit 17: Self-Assessment Checklist (replaces Quiz)	Critiques, Reflections & Quizzes	10 pts	Completion
Unit 17: Capstone (Portfolio + Statement + Exhibition)	Major Studio Projects	20 pts (5-row rubric)	Rubric

6. RUBRICS FOR EVERY TEACHER-GRADED ITEM

This course's build already contains one fixed rubric, reused across every unit rather than re-invented per unit. Every Tier 1 quiz question is auto-gradable (multiple choice, true/false, matching, or image-identification); the course has no free-response quiz items, so no free-response analytic guide is needed. The compact answer keys below back up SpeedGrader/Canvas auto-grading and let you spot-check a flagged response quickly.

Studio Art 9–12 rubric (every Studio Project, and the Unit 17 Capstone)

CRITERION	4 PTS	3 PTS	2 PTS	1 PT
Elements & Principles (that unit's focus)	Applied deliberately and skillfully; choices are clearly intentional	Applied correctly with minor lapses in control	Attempted but inconsistent or unclear	Little or no evidence it was applied
Technique & Craftsmanship	Controlled, careful handling of media; finished with care	Generally controlled with minor rough spots	Inconsistent control; visible rushed areas	Little control; incomplete or careless throughout
Artistic Voice & Intent	A clear personal point of view drives the piece's choices	Some personal choices visible alongside expected ones	Mostly follows the assignment template	No discernible personal choice
Artist Statement	2–3 clear sentences naming specific choices and why	Present and relevant, vague on specifics	Present but thin or loosely related	Missing or unrelated to the artwork
Completion & Signature	Fully finished, signed, correctly filed/named	Finished and signed, minor filing slip	Unfinished in a minor area or missing signature	Substantially incomplete or unsigned

20 points total, 5 rows × 4 pts. Filename convention: 2DArt_U##_Project_LastName (portfolio: 2DArt_U17_Portfolio_LastName). For Unit 17's Capstone, substitute the row labels Breadth / Curation & Cohesion / Reflective Artist Statement / Exhibition Presentation / Completion & Signatures, same 4-level scale and point structure. For Unit 13, the optional family/community interview enhancement does not add a row or change the 20-point total; it can show up as added depth under Artistic Voice & Intent and Artist Statement for a student who completes it, but a student who skips it can still earn full marks in every row.

Quiz answer keys

Format per unit: Q1–Q5 (or Q1–Q6, unit-dependent) are multiple choice, one question is true/false, one is a 4-term matching set, and Q8 is a multiple-choice image-identification question. Quiz type rotates Type A (Elements/Principles) and Type B (Art History) and never repeats back to back across the whole 16-unit sequence, confirmed unit by unit below.

UNIT	QUIZ TITLE	TYPE	ANSWER KEY (Q1–Q8)
1	The Elements of Art	A	1-B · 2-B · 3-C · 4-B · 5-C · 6-True · 7-Matching (Line/Form/Color/Space) · 8-B
2	Cave Art & the Line	B	1-B · 2-C · 3-B · 4-B · 5-C · 6-True · 7-Matching (Blind contour/Continuous line/Gesture line/Ochre) · 8-C
3	Pattern, Balance & Symmetry	A	1-B · 2-B · 3-C · 4-B · 5-C · 6-True · 7-Matching (Motif/Radial balance/Symmetry/Arabesque) · 8-B
4	Leonardo, the Renaissance, and Value	B	1-B · 2-B · 3-C · 4-C · 5-C · 6-True · 7-Matching (Highlight/Cast shadow/Light source/Shadow) · 8-C
6	The Element of Shape	A	1-B · 2-B · 3-B · 4-C · 5-B · 6-True · 7-Matching (Silhouette/Positive shape/Abstracted shape/Organic shape) · 8-B
7	Van Gogh and Texture	B	1-B · 2-C · 3-B · 4-C · 5-B · 6-True · 7-Matching (Hatching/Implied texture/Impasto/Post-Impressionism) · 8-C
8	Form and Value	A	1-B · 2-C · 3-B · 4-C · 5-True · 6-False · 7-Matching (Mass/Highlight/Cast shadow/Cylinder) · 8-C
9	Japanese Art and Space	B	1-B · 2-C · 3-A · 4-C · 5-B · 6-True · 7-Matching (Positive space/Negative space/Figure/Ground) · 8-B
10	Monochromatic Color and Value	A	1-C · 2-C · 3-B · 4-True · 5-B · 6-B · 7-Matching (Hue/Tint/Shade/Contrast) · 8-B
11	Color and the Pointillists	B	1-B · 2-C · 3-B · 4-B · 5-C · 6-True · 7-Matching (Hue/Intensity/Analogous/Tertiary) · 8-C
12	Silhouette, Value, and Emphasis	A	1-C · 2-A · 3-C · 4-B · 5-A · 6-True · 7-Matching (Silhouette/Focal point/Value gradation/Contrast) · 8-B
13	Frida Kahlo and the Symbolic Self-Portrait	B	1-B · 2-B · 3-B · 4-C · 5-B · 6-True · 7-Matching (Self-portrait/Emphasis/Unity/Motif) · 8-B
14	Proportion and the Grid	A	1-B · 2-C · 3-B · 4-C · 5-B · 6-True · 7-Matching (Proportion/Grid method/Unity/Scale) · 8-B
15	Renaissance Perspective	B	1-B · 2-C · 3-B · 4-D · 5-A · 6-True · 7-Matching (Horizon line/Vanishing point/Orthogonal lines/Two-point perspective) · 8-B
16	Mixed Media and the Elements at Work	A	1-B · 2-C · 3-B · 4-A · 5-B · 6-True · 7-Matching (Mixed media/Contrast/Unity/Blackout poetry) · 8-B
17	<i>No content quiz by design.</i> Replaced with a 12-item Self-Assessment Checklist (Yes/Almost/Not Yet) across Breadth, Craftsmanship growth, Curation/cohesion, and Reflective statement/Completion — completion-graded, mirrors the capstone rubric.		

7. DISCUSSION FORUMS, QUIZZES & INTERACTIVE/ASSESSMENT ACTIVITIES

This course has no standalone discussion forum assignment; the VR Session's DAIJ critique and the peer-critique day suggested in Section 2 carry that function instead. Below: general guidance per activity type, then a per-instance table.

General guidance by type

TYPE	HOW IT'S SCORED	TEACHER MOVE
Sketch (Tier 1)	Completion/effort against a short checklist (e.g., both parts present, genuine effort)	Spot-check via the Modules progress view; do not grade in depth
VR Session (Tier 1)	Completion (all parts attempted)	Spot-check screenshots/text; use a sample to gauge whether DAIJ is being applied, not to grade individually
Quiz (Tier 1)	Auto-graded, 8 questions	Skim item analysis each unit; if one question misses widely, that is your outro-triage flag for the week
Studio Project + Artist Statement (Tier 3)	Rubric, 20 pts	The one deep-grading pass per cycle; batch-grade in one sitting using the rubric language in Section 7
Module wrapper (survey)	Completion/participation	Triage for confusion clusters and low-confidence students (Section 3)

Per-instance grading notes

UNIT	STUDIO PROJECT	WHAT FULL CREDIT LOOKS LIKE
1	Design Your Dream Room	All 7 elements identifiable in the room; value used to build depth/form; clear, personal design choice
2	Contour Animal Drawing	Confident, varied-weight contour line; no shading; a real animal reference used and recognizable
3	Islamic Tile Design	Accurate geometric construction (grid/radial), genuine symmetry or balance, finished color pass
4	Value Landscape	Full value range from a single light source; atmospheric depth; black/white/gray only
6	Personal Identity Collage	Mix of geometric/organic cut shapes; negative space used deliberately, not left over; a real personal statement
7	Texture Animal Drawing	At least 2 distinct mark-making textures applied to a chosen animal subject with intention
8	Water Droplet Drawing	Single light source consistent across highlight, form shadow, and cast shadow; reads as 3-D
9	Notan Design	Cut-and-flip technique executed; passes the squint test; balanced positive/negative split
10	Monochromatic Disco Ball	One hue only, full tint-to-shade range, consistent light source builds a believable sphere
11	Color Wheel Design	Accurate 12-hue wheel, correctly mixed secondaries/tertiaries, an original unifying theme
12	Storytelling Silhouette Landscape	Clear silhouette figures over a smooth value-gradient ground; one obvious focal point
13	Symbolic Self-Portrait	At least 3 personal symbols, face as focal point, a limited/unified palette; optional interview does not change credit
14	Grid Enlargement Drawing	Accurate cell-by-cell transfer, consistent proportion and scale, believable enlarged value rendering
15	Two-Point Perspective Cityscape	≥5 structures, two vanishing points on one horizon line, balanced composition
16	Illustrated Blackout Poetry	4–8 kept words from a lawful (public-domain or own) source; illustration uses line/value/contrast/unity deliberately
17	Capstone Portfolio + Statement + Exhibition	6–8 curated pieces show range across the year, a genuine reflective statement, complete VR exhibition evidence

8. COACH, NOT CATCH

Your job is to move each student forward, not to detect and punish. In practice:

- Lead feedback with what is working, then name the next specific step, not just the error.
- Tier 1 practice (Sketch, VR Session) allows re-attempts freely; it is a learning tool, not a one-shot trap.
- Use outro-wrapper analytics and Ignite AI to find students who need help early, then reach out, not to build a case against them.
- If you suspect academic dishonesty or unacknowledged AI use on a Studio Project, open a conversation first: ask the student to walk you through their process and choices. Treat it as formation, not an accusation.
- When you post public model comments during a peer-critique day, highlight strong thinking; do not single out weak work for public correction.

9. WEEKLY ANNOUNCEMENT SCRIPTS

Because students work asynchronously, your weekly announcement is your main visible presence. Clone the template below for any unit; a few situational scripts follow.

Template · Unit launch

Welcome to Unit [N]: [Unit Title]. This week we're looking at [featured artist/work] and learning [concept]. Your Week 1 to-dos: the lesson page, the Sketch, the VR Session, and the Quiz, all due [date]. The one thing not to miss: [tricky concept or step]. [One-line encouragement.]

Unit 1 launch (drafted)

Welcome to 2-D Studio Art! This week we start with Van Gogh's *The Bedroom* and the seven Elements of Art. You'll also take your very first VR session this week, so read the Gallery Manners note before you go in. Your to-dos: the lesson page, the Value Scale sketch, the VR critique, and an 8-question quiz, all due [date]. Don't worry about the Dream Room project yet, that's next week. Welcome aboard.

Unit 6 launch (drafted, first in-copyright artist)

This week's artist is Henri Matisse, and his featured work, *Memory of Oceania*, is under copyright, so you'll open it on the MoMA website in a new tab rather than seeing it on the lesson page itself. Take a full minute with it before you read on. Your to-dos this week: the lesson page, the shape/cut-out sketch, the VR critique, and the quiz, due [date]. Next week you'll build a collage about yourself using what you learn here.

Mid-cycle check-in (Week 2, low-confidence nudge)

Quick check-in: if your confidence on last week's wrapper was low, that's completely normal at this point in a new unit. [Specific concept] trips a lot of students up at first. If you're stuck starting your [Studio Project], try [one concrete unstuck tip]. Reach out any time this week, office hours are [time/link].

Pre-major-assessment reminder

Reminder: your [Studio Project name] and artist statement are due [date]. Before you submit, check the rubric one more time: [1–2 rubric rows most students miss for this project]. Sign your work before you upload it. Excited to see what you've made.

Re-engagement nudge (quiet student)

Hi [student name], I noticed I haven't seen your Unit [N] work yet. No judgment, just checking in: is something in the way, technical, personal, or just needing more time? Let me know and we'll figure out a path forward together. Even a quick message helps.

Unit 13 launch (drafted, sensitive-content advance notice folded in)

This week's artist is Frida Kahlo, and her self-portraits are built from personal symbols, objects that stand for something bigger than themselves. We'll look at her work through a museum link (it's under copyright) and then you'll choose 3 or more symbols from your own life for your own self-portrait. There's an optional add-on this week: interviewing a family or community member about a symbol that represents them. It's optional and won't change your grade either way. If you have any questions about this project before we start, reach out any time.

Unit 17 launch (drafted, capstone/Art Show)

Welcome to the final unit of the year: your Portfolio and Art Show. There's no new artwork and no quiz this cycle, instead you'll curate 6 to 8 pieces from across the whole year, write a reflective statement, and hang a virtual exhibition. Start by gathering and tagging everything you've made; the Careers in Art research is also due this week. We'll close the year with [Art Show event/date]. It's been a real pleasure watching your work grow this year.

10. TEACHER WORKFLOW & WORKLOAD MAP

A normal week

1. Triage the prior unit's outro-wrapper analytics (15–20 min) if wrappers are confirmed live (Section 3).
2. Spot-check a sample of Sketch and VR Session completions via the Modules progress view (~0h graded time).
3. Grade the cycle's one Studio Project + Artist Statement in a single batch sitting using the rubric (~5 min/student, ~8–10 min/student in Unit 17).
4. Post the weekly announcement (Section 9).
5. Answer student/family messages as they arrive.

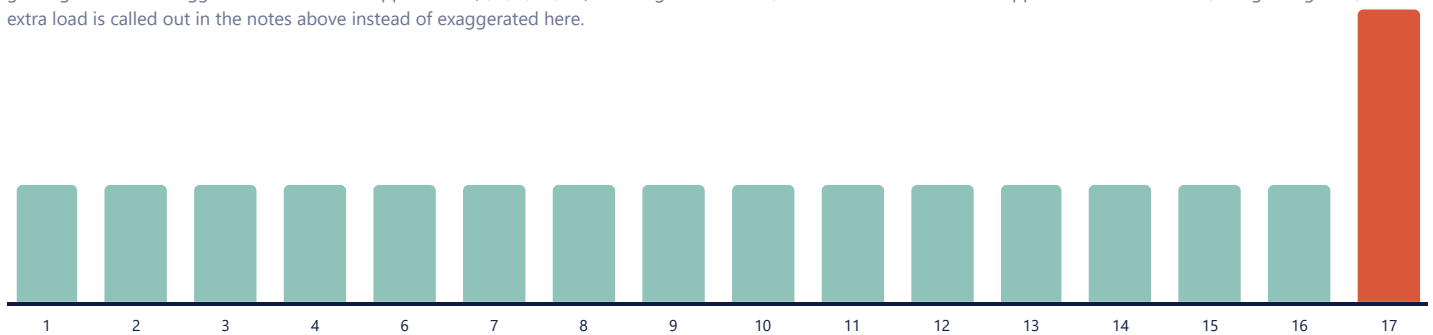
Time budget per optima-canvas-assignments: roughly 0 hours on Tier 1 completion items, 2–3 hours on Tier 2-equivalent review/triage work, and the bulk of grading time concentrated in the one Tier 3 pass each cycle.

Heavier units to flag

- **Unit 1:** same grading load as any other unit, but carries the one-time Gallery Manners VR onboarding; budget extra support time for students' first solo VR session.
- **Unit 3:** the compass-and-straightedge geometric construction is explicitly flagged as the time-heavy part of Week 2; students may need more troubleshooting support even though grading time is unchanged.
- **Unit 6:** the course's first in-copyright artist; expect more "why can't I see the painting" questions the first time a museum link-out appears.
- **Unit 12 and Unit 13:** carry the course's sensitive-content flags (Section 14); budget time to send the advance family notes before these units launch.
- **Unit 17:** the heaviest unit by far. Budget ~8–10 min/student for the capstone rubric (roughly double a normal cycle), plus extra coordination time for gathering a whole year of work, a longer reflective statement, a full VR exhibition, and the new Careers in Art research. Week 1 of this unit is expected to run ~30 minutes over the standard 250-minute budget; the pacing table's generous Q4 buffer (Section 2) is built to absorb this.

Workload-fluctuation graphic

Bar height estimates relative teacher-grading hours per unit for an illustrative 25-student section (~5 min/student × 25 ≈ 2 hours for a standard rubric pass; Unit 17 at ~8–10 min/student × 25 ≈ 3.5–4 hours). All 16 regular units carry the same single Tier 3 rubric pass, so bars are intentionally near-identical; only Unit 17 is genuinely heavier by grading time. Units flagged above for extra support time (1, 3, 6, 12, 13) do not get a taller bar, since that time is student-support/coordination time, not grading time; their extra load is called out in the notes above instead of exaggerated here.



Teal = standard single-rubric-pass load. Coral = heavier capstone load. Hover/inspect each bar's label for the specific reason.

11. STANDARDS COVERAGE MAP

Codes below are read verbatim from each unit's own teacher-cycle-plan.md. Unit 15 and Unit 17's newest code note their own files' request to confirm exact CPALMS wording before quoting in a formal alignment document; both are flagged **VERIFY** below. Never echo these codes to students.

By unit

UNIT	STANDARDS CARRIED
1	VA.912.O.1.1 · VA.912.C.1.1 · VA.912.S.1.3 · VA.912.S.3.4 · VA.912.H.1.1
2	VA.912.H.1.1 · VA.912.S.1.3 · VA.912.S.3.4 · VA.912.C.1.1 · VA.912.O.1.1
3	VA.912.H.1.1 · VA.912.O.1.1 · VA.912.C.2.1 · VA.912.S.2.1
4	VA.912.O.2.1 · VA.912.S.3.4 · VA.912.H.1.1 · VA.912.H.2.2 · VA.912.C.1.1
6	VA.912.O.1.3 · VA.912.C.1.2 · VA.912.S.1.4 · VA.912.H.2.1
7	VA.912.S.2.2 · VA.912.H.1.3 · VA.912.C.2.3 · VA.912.O.3.1
8	VA.912.H.1.3 · VA.912.H.2.1 · VA.912.S.3.1 · VA.912.O.1.3
9	VA.912.O.3.1 · VA.912.H.1.3 · VA.912.S.1.4 · VA.912.F.2.1
10	VA.912.C.1.4 · VA.912.O.3.2 · VA.912.S.2.3
11	VA.912.C.1.4 · VA.912.C.2.2 · VA.912.F.1.1
12	VA.912.S.3.2 · VA.912.O.3.2 · VA.912.C.3.1 · VA.912.H.3.1
13	VA.912.H.1.4 · VA.912.H.2.3 · VA.912.C.2.2 · VA.912.S.2.3
14	VA.912.O.1.4 · VA.912.S.3.3 · VA.912.C.2.4
15	VA.912.O.3.3 · VA.912.S.3.5 · VA.912.H.3.2 VERIFY
16	VA.912.C.3.3 · VA.912.F.2.2 · VA.912.S.3.3
17	VA.912.C.3.3 · VA.912.F.3.1 · VA.912.O.1.4 · VA.912.S.3.5 · VA.912.H.3.1 VERIFY (new, career-awareness) · VA.912.F.3.2 (new, secondary)

By standard family (quick reference)

FAMILY	WHAT IT COVERS	WHERE IT LANDS
C (Critical Thinking)	DAIJ critique, analysis and evaluation of works	Units 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, 7, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 16, 17
H (Historical/Global)	Culture, time, and place of a work; artist's context	Units 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, 7, 8, 9, 12, 13, 15, 17
O (Organizational Structure)	Elements/principles used to build a composition	Units 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 12, 14, 15, 17
S (Skills, Techniques, Processes)	Studio technique and craftsmanship	Units 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17
F (Innovation/Function)	Non-traditional media, art's role in culture/work/career	Units 9, 11, 16, 17

STANDARDS-POOL NOTE

The Q1 standards pool named in build-conventions.md (VA.912.C.1.1, C.1.3, C.2.1, H.1.1, H.2.2, O.1.1, O.2.1, S.1.3, S.2.1, S.3.4) is distributed across Units 1–4; two codes in that pool (C.1.3 and C.2.1) did not appear verbatim in the four Q1 units' own extracted benchmark lists during this inventory pass. Cross-check against the course-shared standards tracker referenced in several units' files before filing a formal FL alignment document.

12. WHAT MAKES THIS COURSE CLASSICAL & CULTIVATING CULTURE

What makes it classical

- **Wonder before mechanism.** Every lesson opens with a full minute of unguided looking at a real work before any vocabulary is introduced (Look First), consistent across all 16 units.
- **A disciplined method for judgment.** DAIJ (Describe, Analyze, Interpret, Judge) is taught once and used in every single unit's Watch It Work section and every VR critique, so judgment is always earned in order rather than blurred.
- **The Great Conversation across centuries.** Students meet anonymous cave and Islamic artisans, da Vinci, Van Gogh, Seurat, Picasso, Matisse, Douglas, Kahlo, Close, and Blake in sequence, each answering the same seven-elements toolkit in a different way.
- **Apprenticeship through the atelier ladder.** Every unit names its rung (study/copy, variation, invention-prep), so students consciously move from copying a master's approach to inventing their own use of it, rather than free-drawing without a model.

Cultivating culture asynchronously

- Use the peer-critique day suggested in every live-unit box (Section 2) to build a real crit culture; model DAIJ language in your own comments.
- Name good thinking publicly in weekly announcements ("several of you noticed X in the outro this week").
- The virtue thread shows up concretely here: courtesy (Gallery Manners, taught once and expected all year), perseverance (multi-day grid rendering, geometric construction), honesty (own work only in the portfolio, correct copyright handling modeled by every unit), courage (sharing a personal self-portrait or a family interview), and responsibility (every artwork signed).
- Treat feedback as relationship, not transaction: a specific rubric comment plus a warm one-line note does more for an asynchronous student than points alone.

13. SENSITIVE-CONTENT FLAGS & FAMILY/STUDENT SCRIPTS

Two units in this course carry content worth an advance notice. No other unit in the inventory surfaced sensitive or mature content.

UNIT 12 · AARON DOUGLAS AND THE HARLEM RENAISSANCE

Where: Unit 12, Week 1 lesson and quiz. **What:** historical content on race and the Harlem Renaissance, handled neutrally and factually per the course's own build notes; the critical-reception debate is deliberately deferred, not part of this unit.

Suggested advance script, Unit 12

Next week in Studio Art, we'll study Aaron Douglas, a leading painter of the Harlem Renaissance, and his mural series Aspects of Negro Life. We'll look at his use of silhouette and light through a museum link (the work is under copyright) and talk about the historical moment it came from. The focus stays on the art itself, its technique and its history. If you have any questions before we begin, please reach out to me at [contact info].

UNIT 13 · FRIDA KAHLO AND THE SYMBOLIC SELF-PORTRAIT

Where: Unit 13, both weeks. **What:** a self-portrait project built from personal and family symbols touches on students' own identity and family life; an optional Week 2 enhancement invites interviewing a family or community member. Biographical content on Kahlo is kept neutral and factual; mature biographical detail is deliberately not part of the lesson.

Suggested advance script, Unit 13

Next week's artist is Frida Kahlo, known for self-portraits built from personal symbols rather than a plain likeness. Students will choose three or more objects or images from their own lives to build a symbolic self-portrait, and there's an optional add-on where a student may interview a family or community member about a symbol that represents them; it is entirely optional and will not affect the grade either way. If your student would rather keep their symbols private from classmates, that's completely fine, the project only asks that the symbols mean something to them. Questions are always welcome at [contact info].